

EMERGENCY VERBAL REPORTING PROTOCOL

Verbal reporting is used where a clear and imminent threat has been identified, or when an incident has occurred. Verbal reporting occurs in the first seconds or minutes of an emergency before written reporting occurs to activate a management response.

The passage of information from the person identifying a threat or responding to an emergency must be clear and timely to ensure that critical information is shared with the appropriate people and groups quickly and effectively. This allows for good decisions to be made and for resources and support to be effectively mobilized. Anyone who identifies or is managing an emergency must be able to report information quickly, clearly and effectively.

This emergency verbal reporting protocol should be made available to all personnel and should be placed at locations where the system can be seen, absorbed and used in an emergency.

This emergency verbal reporting protocol can be used as part of both training and exercising programs to reinforce understanding and the application of the incident reporting system.



The Emergency Verbal Reporting System

- **What:** What actually happened – provide the specific details of the event
- **Where:** Where exactly did the event happen – provide the specific location or area
- **When:** What was the specific date and time of the event
- **Why:** Why did the event happen – is there a background or context to the situation
- **Who:** Who is involved – especially as it relates to injuries or deaths
- **Who:** Who is managing the situation – provide their name(s), contact details and title
- **What:** What assistance is required – do not be afraid to ask for help!
- **Risks:** What are the immediate, near-term and long-term risks
- **Impacts:** What are the implications if the risks do occur